

Brenda Carson

Summary

Senior QA/Testing professional, 22 years in. Track record of taking ambiguous problems through design, delivery and the unglamorous operational work that follows. I mentor deliberately and write things down. Core stack: CI/CD, Python, Java.

Selected Highlights

- » Automated 5 regression suites with CI/CD, cutting the manual test cycle by 30%.
- » Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 6% to 92%.
- » Built a performance harness in Cypress simulating 4k concurrent users.

Experience

Principal QA Engineer, Northbridge IT

November 2016 to Present

- » Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.
- » Owned release sign-off for 8 services, coordinating across product and support.
- » Reduced escaped defects by 20% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- » Established test data management practices later adopted by 8 teams.
- » Drove accessibility coverage from 20% to 94% of core journeys.

QA Engineer, Uber

November 2007 to June 2016

- » Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- » Integrated automated checks into the Kubernetes pipeline, blocking 50 faulty releases.
- » Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 50 hours to 3 minutes through parallelisation.
- » Mentored 3 manual testers into automation roles.

Ironwood Consulting — Test Automation Engineer

January 2006 to June 2007

- » Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Cypress, catching defects staging had missed.
- » Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- » Introduced written design docs and an RFC process, cutting rework late in delivery.

QA Analyst, Ridgeline Analytics

September 2004 to October 2005

- » Reduced technical debt on a legacy component that had blocked 20 previous attempts.
- » Presented the team's work at an internal engineering forum of 150+ colleagues.
- » Managed stakeholder communication during a major incident, including the post-mortem.

Palantir — Junior Quality Engineer

December 2002 to June 2004

- » Ran retrospectives and drove the follow-up actions to completion, not just to the board.
- » Represented the team in cross-functional planning with product, design and support.
- » Interviewed and onboarded 3 new hires, shaping the hiring bar for the team.

Academic Background

High School

Richardsonview High School | 1998 to 2002

Technical Skills

CI/CD • Python • Java • TypeScript • Cypress • JavaScript • Playwright • pytest • GitHub Actions • Postman • Selenium • AWS • SQL • Redshift • Kubernetes • Snowflake

Training & Certifications

Google Analytics Certification — Google, 2023

Volunteer Experience

Maintainer of a small open-source Playwright library used by a handful of teams.

Personal Interests

Open-source contribution, Chess, Cycling